

SPOT AND LEARN

Plan a trip to a young forest or a mature forest with your friends and see how many different plants you can identify. Carry a notebook with you and write down your observations in it.



Young forest

After about 25 to 50 years, younger, faster-growing trees have taken over the site, shading out many of the smaller shrubs. The leaves they shed each year also change the nutrients in the soil.

Mature forest

After 50 to 150 years or so, what was once a young forest is now filled with bigger, sturdier trees. The canopy is thicker and fewer shrubs grow beneath it, unless some trees die or lose branches, letting in more light.

